Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years designing complex B2B products and building and maintaining production design systems.

Co-led the Abax design system across five squads at Abacum, including its contribution model, then built Remuner's system from scratch as its sole designer.

Case study: manel-leiva.com/cases/design-systems

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Owned product design across Remuner's sales-compensation platform as its sole designer. Scope spanned data integrations, compensation plans and payouts, rep and manager experiences, and approval workflows.
- Built the component library and design system from scratch, starting with a deliberately small token set, and added ESLint rules that enforced use of system components.
- Owned the design side of the token pipeline; used Codex to add CI validation, drift detection, and smoke tests through engineering-reviewed PRs.
- Used the Figma MCP with an AI agent to manage tokens and sync them with code, run accessibility checks, and write component documentation.
- Built interactive prototypes through AI-assisted workflows for users to test, separate from the production application.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Designed workflows across Abacum's data-integration and financial-modeling areas, first in the Integrations squad and later Engine.
- Co-led the Abax design-system business case with the head of design and presented it to engineering leadership; the work was selected for dedicated design and engineering time.
- Proposed and ran the contribution model across five squads, keeping proposals in a separate exploration library so only reviewed components reached the canonical one.
- Settled recurring component disputes: wrote the naming convention the team adopted, and resolved read-only state by adapting an existing MUI state.
- Moved squads to Abax components behind feature flags, with each squad adding its own migration tickets. A monthly codebase count put Abax at about 47% of tracked component uses at departure.

Senior Product Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; designed websites and products for media, retail, finance, legal, and culture clients.
- Built CMS-connected front ends, reusable component libraries, and a shared starter kit with a build pipeline and CSS variables.
- Mentored junior practitioners and taught UX, components, and digital design.

SKILLS

Design systems: Contribution and governance models, token architecture, Figma variables and libraries, component states and variants, documentation, adoption tracking, migration planning
Design to code and AI: Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, GitHub, ESLint, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Codex, Figma MCP with Claude, AI-assisted prototyping
Product design and research: Complex B2B workflows, interaction design, customer interviews, structured user testing
Languages: Catalan and Spanish (native), English (fluent, C1)

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002